Harbor Point Mutual Auto Insurance

Bodily Injury Unit

Claim Notes

Claim number:	C-1381
Claimant:	Suzanne Nelson
Adjuster:	Valerie Rodriguez

07/09/2023
Claimant reports a sideswipe while changing lanes and states that the other vehicle struck the driver's side as they merged. Claimant is not represented by an attorney and has given a recorded statement.

07/17/2023
Policy confirms the driver is listed as a named insured and the vehicle is covered under the policy in force at the time of loss. Nothing in the file suggests the damage predates the coverage start.

07/19/2023
Police report and two independent witnesses place the claimant inside the vehicle at the scene. Claimant reports neck and back pain beginning shortly atfer the impact.

08/06/2023
Photos of the vehicle show dents on the passenger side, at a lower height than the contact point described by the claimant. The damage pattern does not clearly line up with the account given so far.

08/11/2023
Reviewed a nearby business camera covering the stretch of road. The footage shows no contcat between vehicles at the location and time reported.

08/17/2023
In a follow-up call, claimant now says the other car came from the opposite direction and that two passengers were present. The first statement described a single occupant and a different direction of travel.

08/23/2023
Requested prior claims history for the vehicle and found no earlier damage recorded. Claimant also has no known prior injury to the neck or back on file.

09/24/2023
Claimant was seen at an urgent care clinic and then referred to physical therapy. Clinic notes describe muscle strain consistent with a side impact of this kind.

11/19/2023
Physical therapy notes show steady improvement over several weeks, with sessions becoming less frequent as range of motion returned. Treatment appears to have followed a normal course for this type of injury.

11/27/2023
Re-interviewed the claimant about the camera footage and the discrepancies in the earlier statements. Claimant said the recolelction of direction and passengers may have been mixed up due to stress after the event.

01/18/2024
Sent the vehicle damage findings and the footage summary to the damage review unit for an independent assessment. Awaiting their opinion on whether the damage matches the reported impact.

01/29/2024
Current status: injury plausible for this type of crash, treatment tapered as expected, and coverage confirmed. Claim remains open pending the damage review and a decision on the discrepancies in the camera evidence and the claimant's statements.

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Recorded Statement

Claim number:	C-1381
Statement of:	Suzanne Nelson
Taken by:	Valerie Rodriguez
Date:	06/30/2023

Q: Thank you for agreeing to give this recorded statement. Please state your full name for the record.

A: I'd rather just say my name is not needed here, but if it's required, I can confirm I'm the driver of the vehicle involved.

Q: That's fine. Can you describe where the collision happened?

A: It was on a multi-lane city street in Houston, Texas, heading toward the on-ramp area. Traffic was moving steadily.

Q: Walk me through what you were doing right before the impact.

A: I was in the right lane and wanted to move over to the left lane because a delivery truck ahead was slowing down. I checked my mirror and looked over my shoulder, but I think the other car was in my blind spot.

Q: Did you signal before changing lanes?

A: Yes, I put my turn signal on a few seconds before I started to move.

Q: What happened when you moved over?

A: The other vehicle sideswiped the rear quarter panel of my car. I felt a hard jolt and heard the scraping sound. I steered back toward the shoulder and stopped.

Q: Were you injured at the scene?

A: Not obviously. I was stiff, but I thought I would be fine. By the next morning my neck was tight and my lower back was sore, especially when I sat for long periods.

Q: Have you sought medical treatment since the collision?

A: Yes, I went to a clinic and was told I have a neck and back strain. I've been doing physical therapy twice a week.

Q: Is there anything else you'd like to add to your statement?

A: Only that I've been careful to follow the treatment plan and I'm willing to provide my medical records.

Q: Thank you. This concludes the statement.

A: Thank you.